

Using Employee Ideas to drive Innovation

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Innovation can come from anywhere in the organization

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Amazon Prime originated from an employee idea from someone in IT development. In 2013 Morningstar analysts estimated that Prime members generated \$78 more profit per customer than non-members.



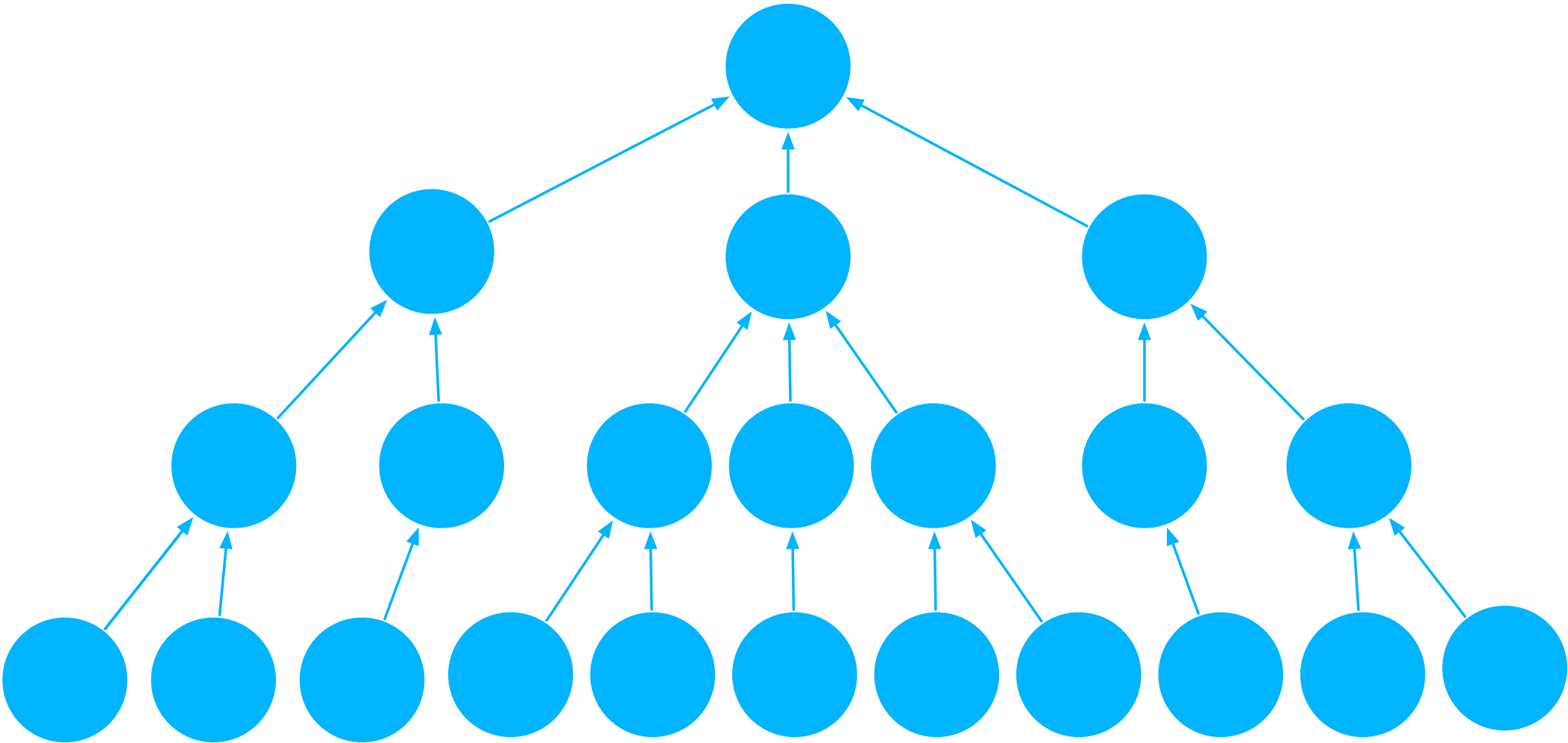
70%

Executives believe
innovation to be one of
key drivers of growth

35%

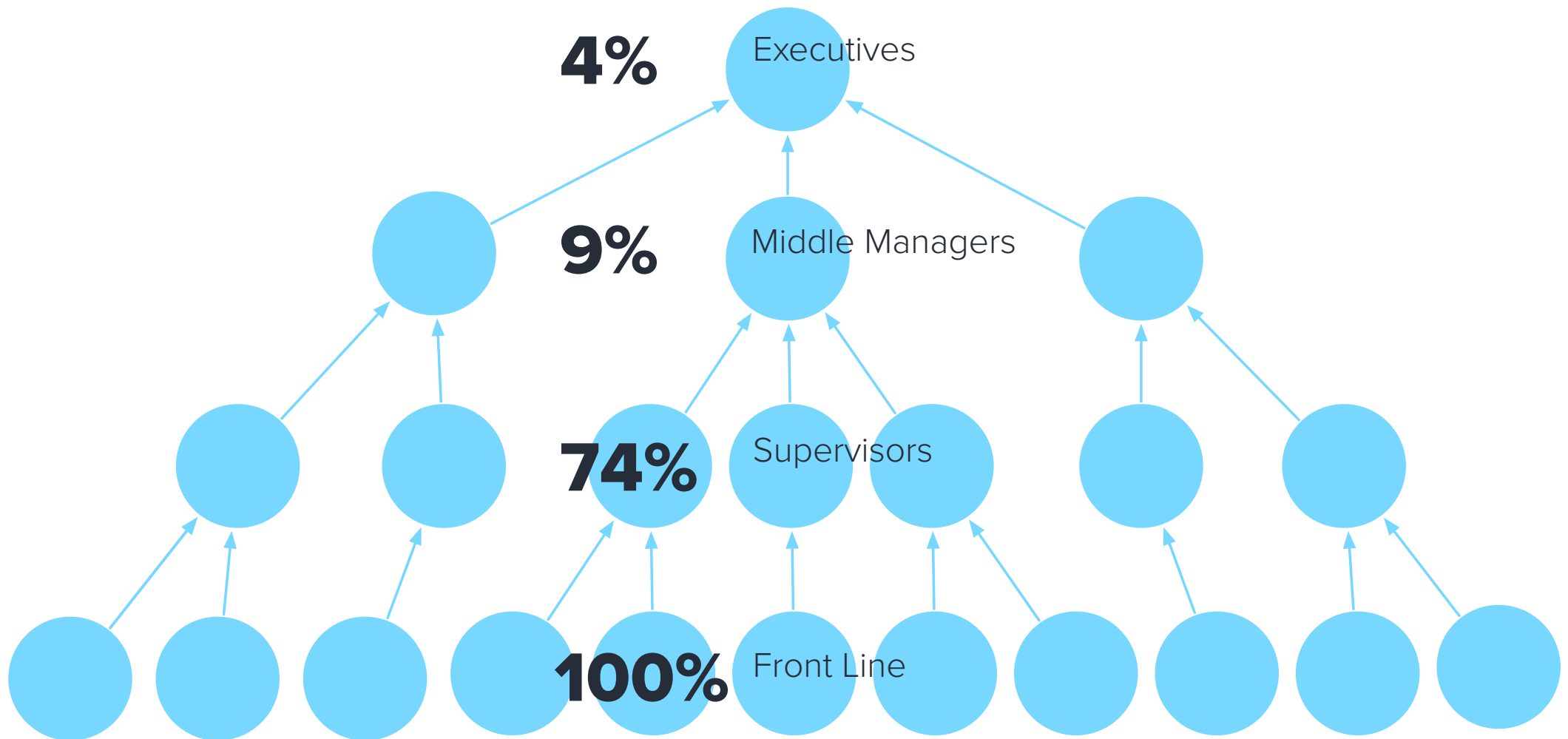
Executives are
confident about their
innovation decisions

Tradition upward employee communication



Sydney Yoshida's Iceberg of Ignorance

How information about issues travels through an organization



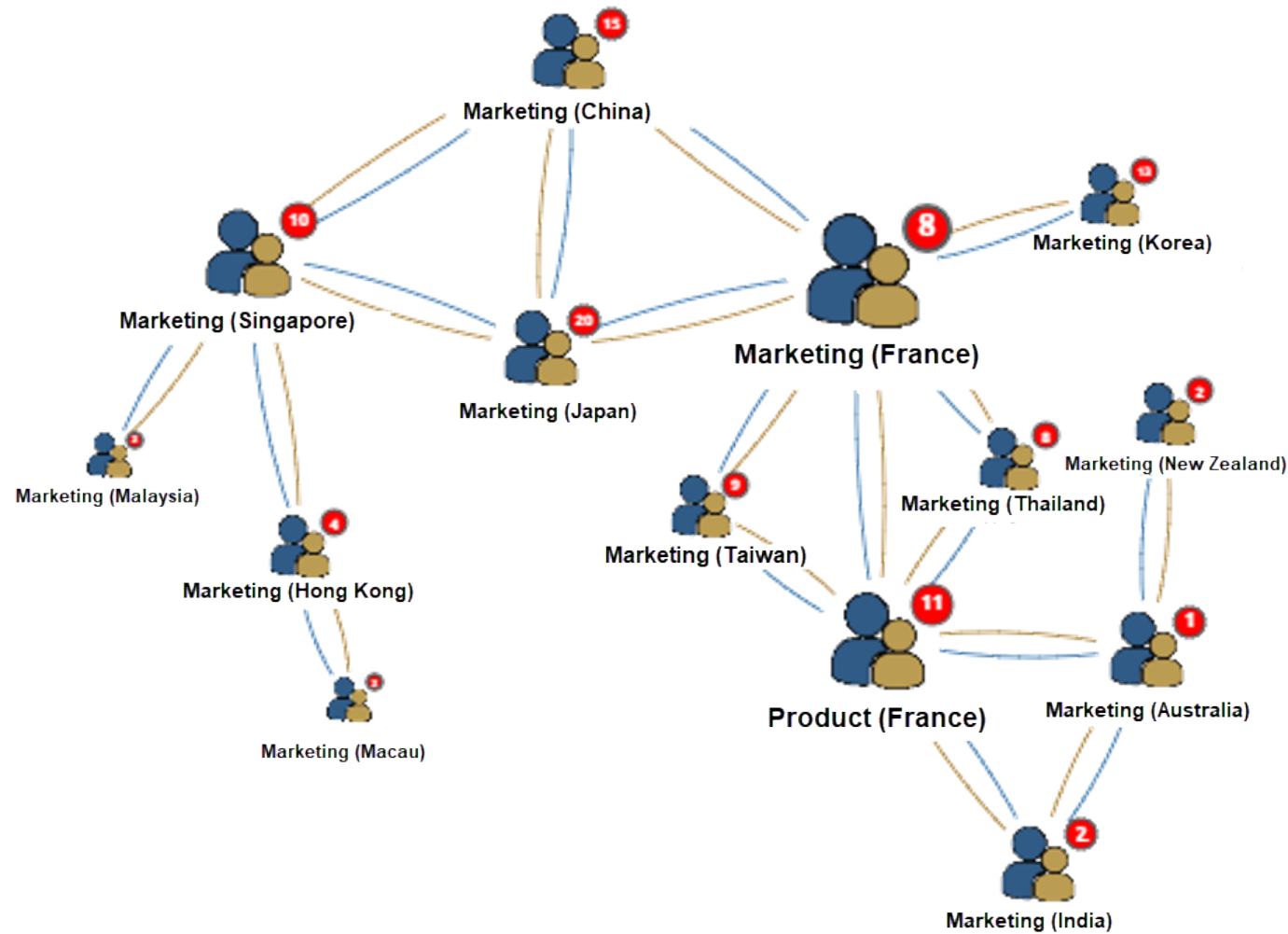
“Paradoxically, the analysis revealed that those employees, largely **middle managers**, with the most negative attitude toward innovation were also the most highly sought after for advice about it. In effect, they **served as bottlenecks to the flow of new ideas and the open sharing of knowledge**”

McKinsey Quarterly, “Innovation & Leadership”

Network analysis to understand real communication patterns

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Inter-departmental communication patterns, French-based global business.

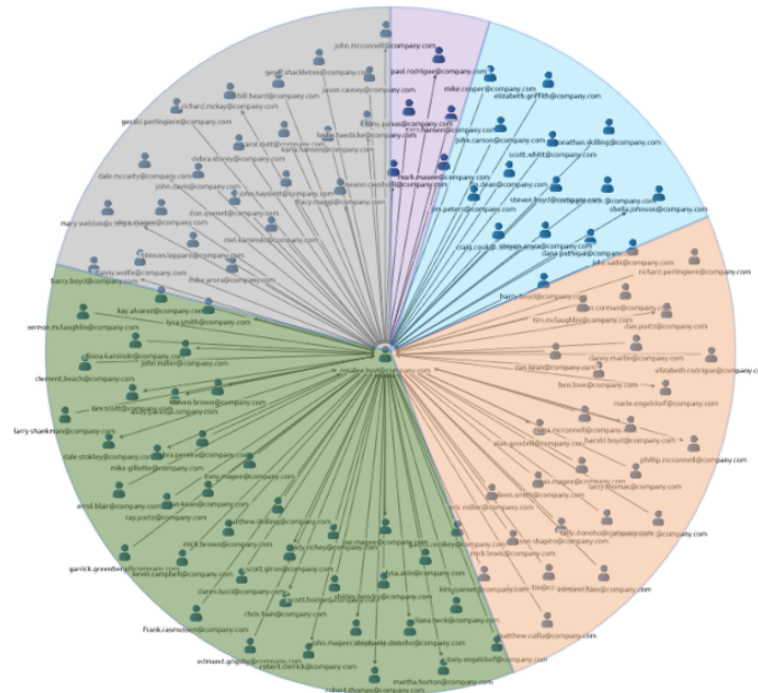


Source: Trustsphere

We build networks with individuals like ourselves

Our natural relationship-building process reduces diversity of background and ideas. This process reduces our ability to identify innovative ideas.

Employee with 10 years tenure, strongest relationships



Tenure		Number of Working Relationships
	0-5 years	4
	6-10 years	12
	11-15 years	22
	16-20 years	30
	21+ years	18

Source: TrustSphere

Directed

Surveys

Focus Groups

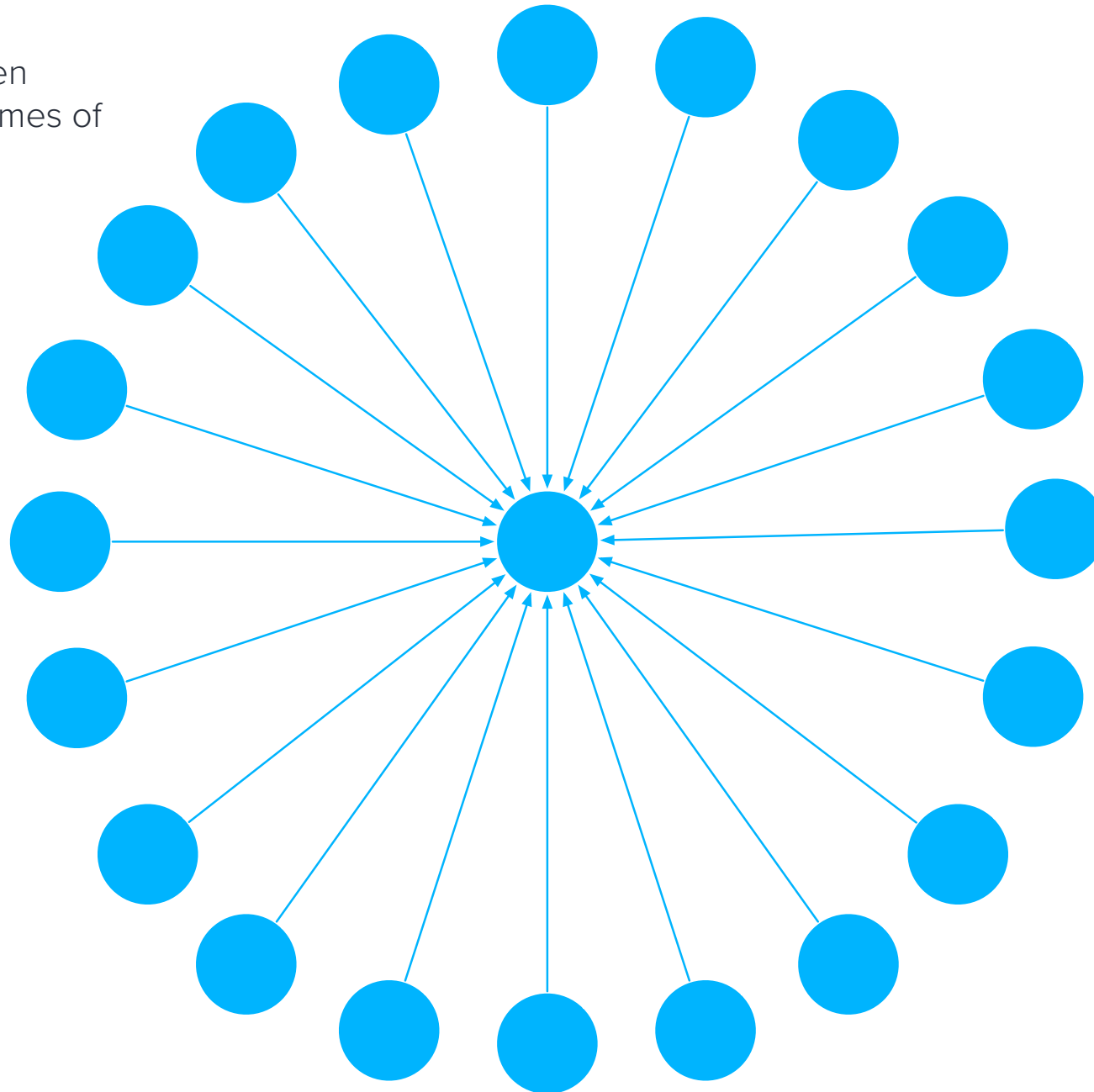
Passive

Idea boxes

Quality Circles

Survey-based upward communication

Executives ask a few open questions, get large volumes of answers



Demands an efficient solution to analyse large volumes of data

Ask questions about your pressing business issues

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“How can we improve customer experience in our stores?”

“What could we do to improve the performance review process?”

“What could we do to improve your working life here?”

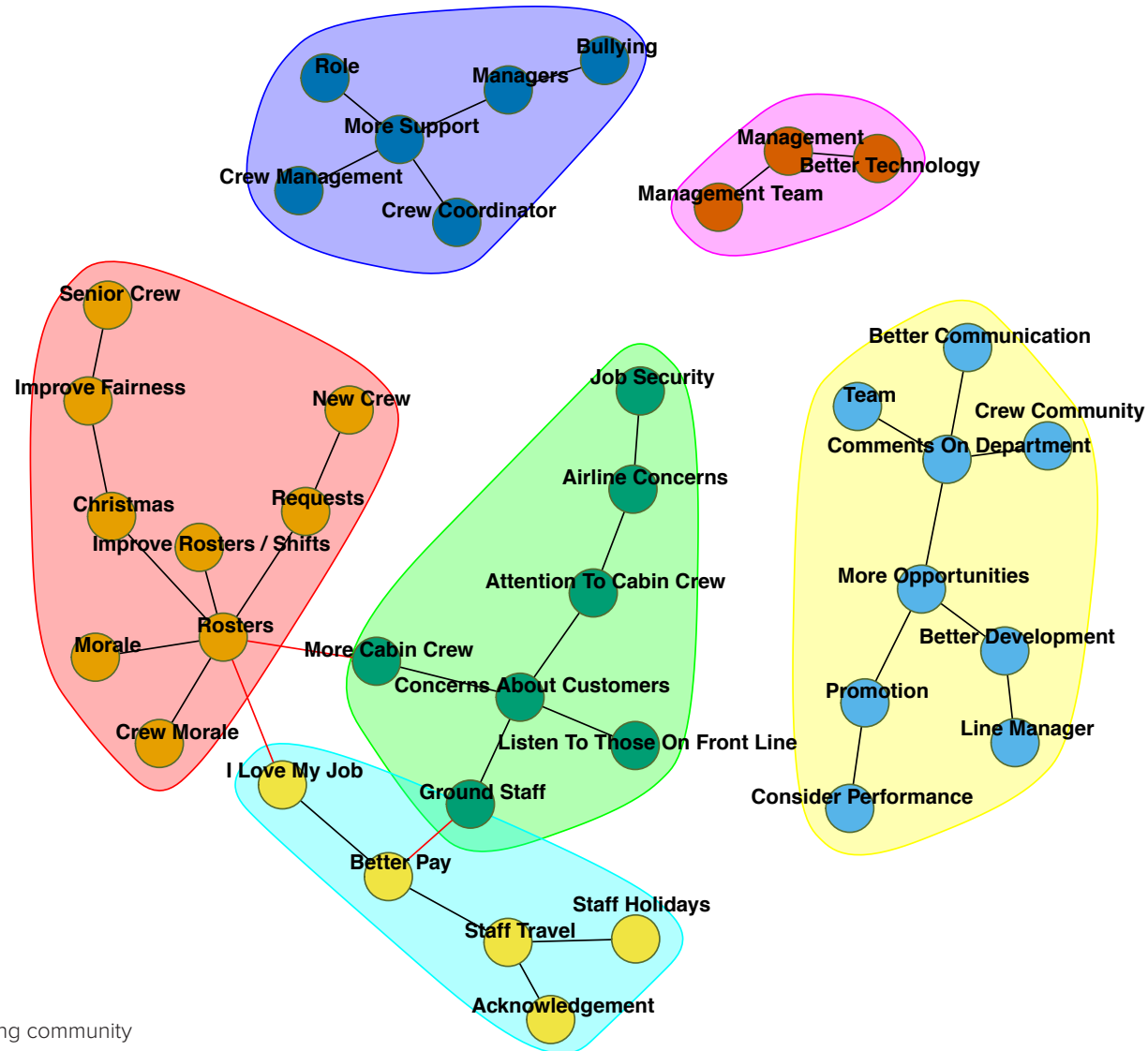
“What ideas do you have to improve the Christmas sales period?”

“How could HR improve the services they provide you as a manager?”

“If you were our Brand Director, what would you do first?”

Additional insight

Most clients ask us to identify additional insight from their responses, either looking just at the text data or combining it with other employee information.

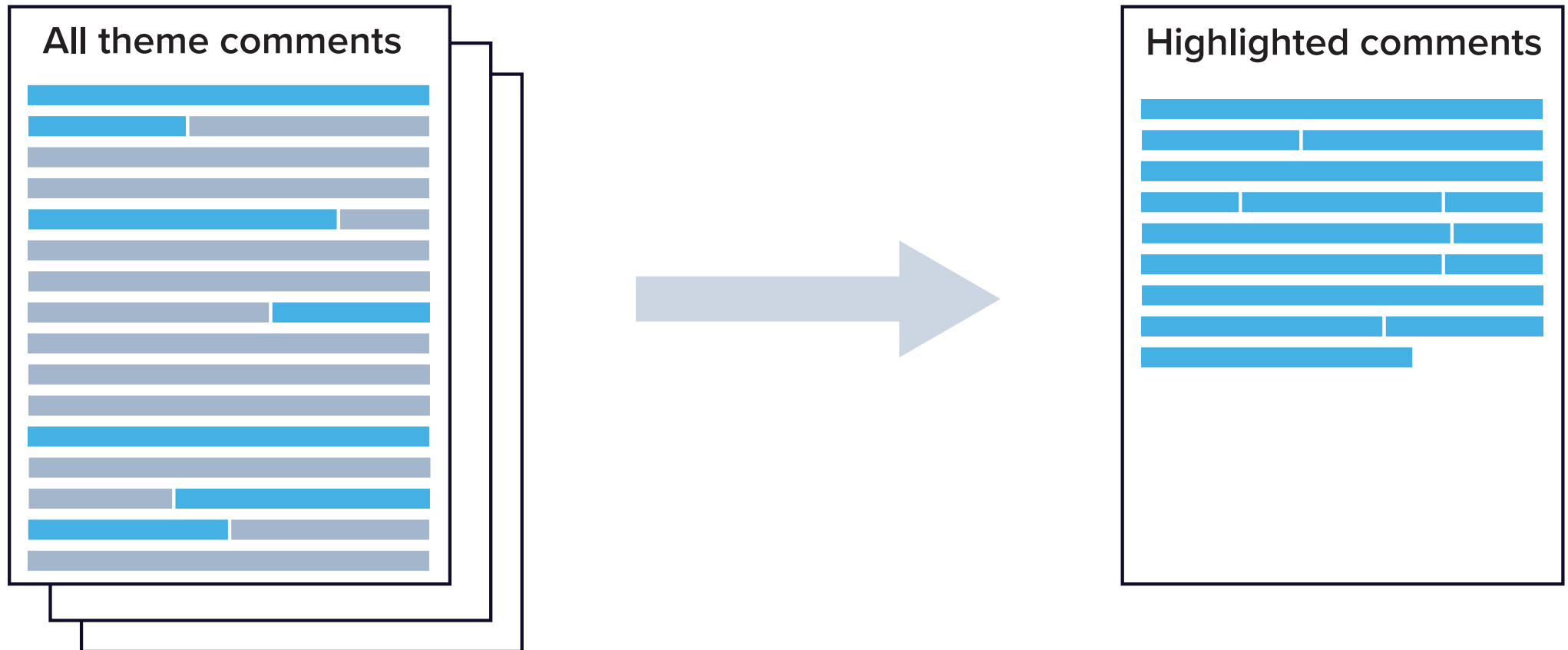


A probabilistic co-occurrence network using community detection to identify which themes employees are most likely to talk about together.

Summarising underlying text

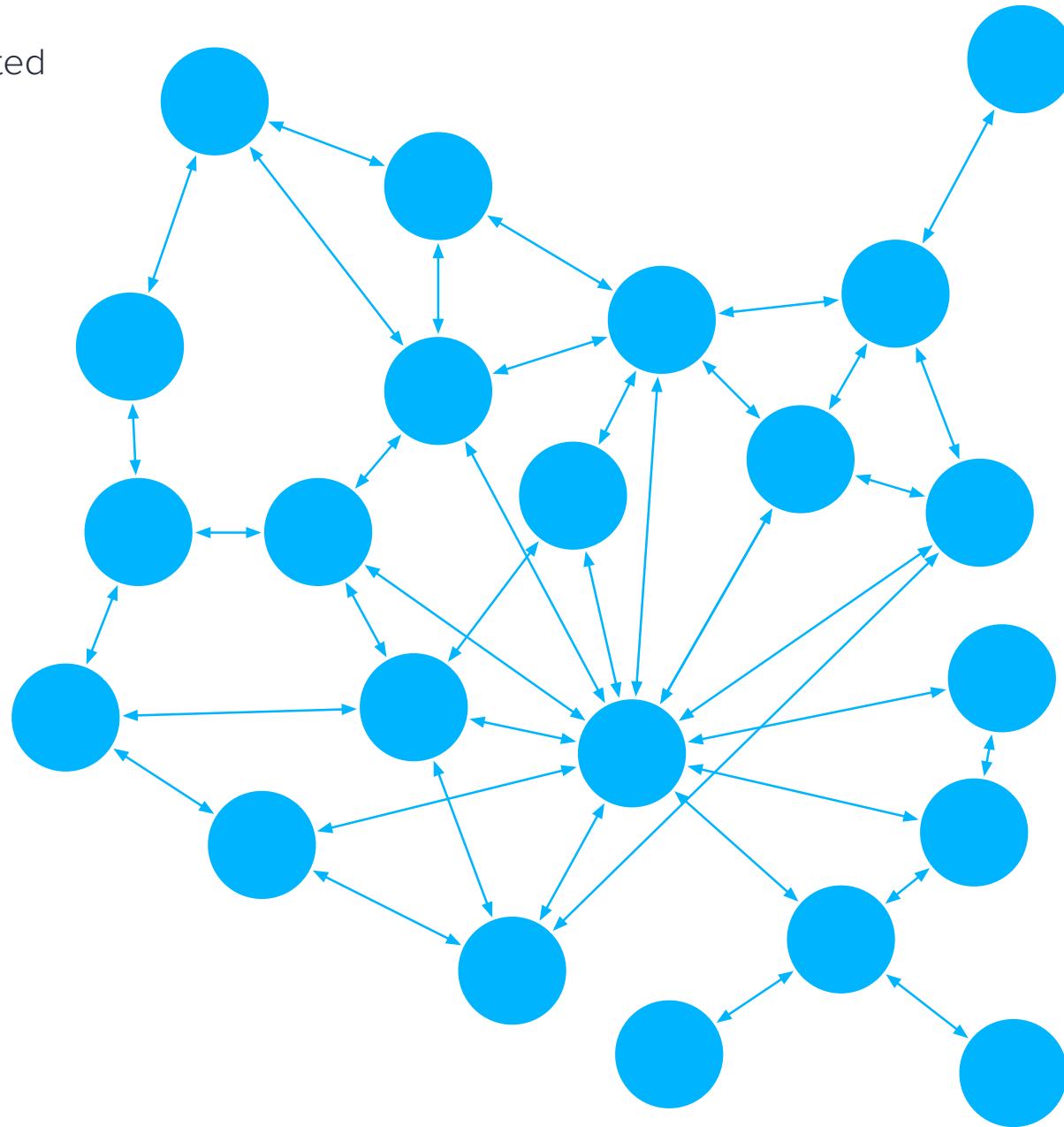
We use proprietary document summarisation algorithms to identify example sentences

Subtext



Working-group based

Workgroups are often moderated like in a focus group



Electronic focus group solutions

VisionLab is an example of one of many technologies that enable firms to collect and prioritise ideas and comments

VISIONLAB

LEADERBOARD

ENGAGEMENT

THEMES

ALL IDEAS

MY IDEAS

1st 	Establish more cross-functional activities such as training or mentoring. This would enable employees to better understand the business as a whole and share ideas between departments and functions. 100 Score, 0 Comments COMMENT 
2nd 	Working here needs to be fun again, bring back more frequent company social events. 94 Score, 0 Comments COMMENT 
3rd 	We must work towards bringing back the "spirit" and "morale" of people to truly inspire action. I suggest rewarding employees in public setting that exemplify the pillars of our values. COMMENT 

Thoughts on innovation through employees

There is not one perfect solution

Build suitable
innovation networks:

Use Organization
Network Analysis

Collect and understand
company wide ideas:

Survey-based text
analysis

Prioritise and add
further details to
selected ideas:

Innovation Platforms

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